

Challenges in Platform Selection



This article examines the criteria for selecting a software platform, including special requirements, and the various features that the architect needs to consider while making the choice.

To begin, let's cover some fundamentals about operating systems. An operating system is an environment that enables users to execute their programs on the system hardware. Without an operating system, users need to write applications at a machine level, which only the hardware

can understand and execute. However, this is extremely difficult, and besides, it's not portable to different hardware sets—thus the need for an environment in which a person can use a high-level language to interact with the system. Besides interfacing between user and hardware, the operating system provides several other important and useful features,